Fateme Yalpanian

UX & Behavioral Researcher | Quantitative & Qualitative Methods | Surveys · Experiments · Eye-Tracking · R

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PROFILE

Researcher with master's degrees in Clinical Linguistics and Industrial & Organizational Psychology. I combine quantitative methods (experiments, surveys, psychometric scales, mixed-effects models in R) with qualitative ones (interviews, benchmarking, personas, workshops), and I set the quality bar before collecting data. Experienced in recruiting 100+ participants, running studies end to end, and turning results into clear recommendations. English C2, Dutch B1.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Intern | Ghent University, Belgium 2026

Eye-tracking study of language prediction (M.Sc. thesis); poster talk at AMLaP 2026

- Built and validated stimuli in **two online norming surveys (~100 participants)**: set a ≥75% cloze threshold in advance, mirrored the eye-tracking display, and added a name-agreement check. 60 of 80 items passed; failing items were rewritten and retested rather than lowering the bar.
- Preregistered (OSF), programmed (PsychoPy) and ran a 2 × 2 Visual World eye-tracking experiment; **recruited 100+ native Belgian-Dutch speakers, 96 analyzed** after pre-defined exclusions.
- Analyzed fixation data in R with **linear mixed-effects models and divergence-point analysis**; showed that sound-based prediction precedes meaning-based prediction without delaying it, supporting a parallel model.
- Ran sessions in Dutch where needed, documented every session, and coordinated schedules with supervisors and lab staff.

R&D and HR Intern | Hamrah-e Aval Academy (MCI), Tehran 2022–2023

- Employee experience: administered validated job satisfaction, motivation and quality-of-work-life questionnaires to **50+ employees**; benchmarked item scores against published norms, flagged below-standard items, and presented prioritized themes to management.
- Online teaching platform: co-led **interviews with teachers and leaders of an existing education platform**; translated their needs into a two-sided business model canvas for a teacher-mentoring platform (two iterations).
- Internship funnel: facilitated a diagnostic workshop on low applications and post-internship attrition; recommended attraction and retention measures to academy leadership.

PROJECTS

- **Language-learning app** (co-founder, ongoing): competitor benchmarking, user personas and iterative learning-flow design in Figma.
- **Serious game for children with dyslexia** (M.Sc. coursework, team lead of 4): outlined a VR and an app-based concept, weighing multisensory learning fit against accessibility.
- **Speech and cognition**: Praat scripts for TextGrid generation and voice-quality analysis of dysarthric speech, Nemours database (GitHub); Simon task measuring inhibitory control, programmed in JavaScript (live demo).
- **Speaker verification** (team of 3): compared ECAPA-TDNN and ReDimNet embeddings on 114 TIMIT speakers across enrollment sizes and scoring methods; equal error rate below 0.5% in every setting; built an interactive same/different-speaker demo. Course work: pitch-based gender classification (5 classifiers, best 96% accuracy), CNN, LSTM and Transformer models on MFCCs (speaker demo, course notebooks).

SKILLS

Quantitative: Experimental design, survey design and norming, psychometric scales, preregistration, linear mixed-effects models, divergence-point analysis, machine learning, data visualization

Qualitative: User and stakeholder interviews, competitor benchmarking, personas, workshop facilitation

Tools: R (lme4, ggplot2, patchwork), Python (scikit-learn, PyTorch, librosa), JavaScript, SPSS, Jamovi, Qualtrics, PsychoPy, Experiment Builder, Praat, Figma, LaTeX, Microsoft Office

EDUCATION

M.Sc. (Research) European Master's in Clinical Linguistics (EMCL++) | Groningen · Ghent · Eastern Finland 2024–2026

Thesis: Can Phonological Prediction Precede Semantic Prediction? (grade 9/10). Supervisors: Prof. Robert J. Hartsuiker, Dr. Esperanza R. Badaya. Erasmus Mundus scholarship (€50,000).

M.Sc. Industrial and Organizational Psychology | Shahid Beheshti University, Tehran 2021–2024

B.Sc. Psychology | Shahid Beheshti University, Tehran 2017–2021

Thesis on psychological determinants of COVID-19 conspiracy beliefs (19.75/20), published 2021.

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Host & Service Staff | La Patrona Cantina Mexicana, The Hague 2026–present

- Read guest needs in real time and resolve requests and complaints on the spot; manage reservations and events from first client contact to delivery, coordinating floor, kitchen and management.
- Train and onboard new staff and lead a closing team; in assistant-manager training.

English Teacher (General & IELTS) | Self-employed; Ghotb-e Ravandi Institute; ACECR, Shahid Beheshti University 2017–2024

- Tracked each learner's progress against target outcomes and adjusted plans; built reusable lesson templates and assessment rubrics.
- Revised the curriculum each term with colleagues based on what worked; hired as the youngest instructor at ACECR after an A++ teaching demonstration.

English–Persian Translator | Self-employed 2017–2019

- Translated subtitles, documentaries and scientific articles, adapting tone and cultural references to each audience.

PUBLICATIONS & PRESENTATIONS

- Yalpanian, F., Hartsuiker, R., & Badaya, E. (2026). Testing a parallel model of prediction by production via Visual World Paradigm in eye-tracking: Can phonological prediction precede semantic prediction? AMLaP 2026 (poster talk), Saarland University. Preregistration on OSF.
- Nejat, P., Rezvandel Ramzi, F., & Yalpanian, F. (2021). A review of COVID-19 conspiracy theories and psychological determinants and consequences of belief in them. Rooyesh-e-Ravanshenasi Journal, 10(7), 199–212.

LANGUAGES & RECOGNITION

Languages: Farsi (native), English (C2, IELTS 8.5), Dutch (B1), Spanish (A2)

Recognition: Erasmus Mundus Joint Master's Scholarship (2024); top 0.1% nationwide in the Iranian university entrance exam (70th of 167,080, 2017); Teacher Training Course with distinction (2019)

Training: UX/UI course; Statistics and Data Visualization for Linguistics (R)